Overview

Description
Expand Middesk's Verify report to cover Canada, Europe, and APAC, starting with core business attributes. GA target: late April / early May.

People-related attributes (e.g., UBO verification) are scoped as a fast-follow to protect the initial launch timeline. Our vendor shortlist already supports this path - vendors like Kyckr offer broader geo coverage for future expansion and native support for people-related attributes, enabling UBO use-cases once validated.

Problem
Business activity is now increasingly global by default. Companies need cross-border payments, international customer onboarding, and multi-region expansion. Customers and prospects want a single, full-stack solution with global reach - not fragmented regional vendors.

Impact

Core Hypotheses

- **Business Impact:** International KYB coverage unlocks $10M+ in Enterprise pipeline opportunities in 2026/27.
- **Customer Impact:** Customers and prospects can expand internationally and onboard foreign entities through a single, best-in-class US + Global KYB provider.

- [Q2 2026 Impact]
  - **Unblock and speed up international onboarding** - Customers can verify businesses in Canada, EU, and APAC via existing Verify integration
  - **Vendor consolidation** - Replace or avoid regional point solutions for covered markets
  - **Stronger, more consistent compliance posture** - Uniform oversight across domestic and international entities
- [Longer-Term Impact]
  - **Global entity graph** - Richer connections across business relationships, ownership, and affiliations worldwide
  - **Enhanced risk signals** - Cross-border patterns surface hidden risk (e.g., shell companies, sanctions exposure)
  - **Network effects** - Insights from aggregate international verifications improve data quality over time. More data points = better decisioning models and auto-approval rates
  - **Future-proof for UBO/beneficial ownership** - Entity graph lays groundwork for full ownership mapping when people data is added

Target Audience

- **Verticals**
  - [P0]: High-growth fintechs, neobanks, blockchain services expanding internationally
  - [P1]: Mature enterprises with existing international presence
  - [P2]: Marketplaces and platforms onboarding global sellers/merchants
- **Personas**
  - Compliance/Risk Officers - need consistent global verification to satisfy regulators
  - Operations Leads - onboarding speed, manual review reduction
  - Product Managers - need to unblock international expansion without building custom integrations per region
- **Use-Cases**
  - Cross-border payments merchant onboarding
  - Platform/marketplace seller verification (EU, APAC, Canada)

    - Expanding lending or card products to new regions
    - Verify international business entities on behalf of domestic clients

JTBD

- Onboard international businesses faster
- Maintain consistent compliance oversight across all regions
- Expand into new markets without adding vendors or manual processes
- Reduce operational complexity of multi-region KYB

Solution

Return business attributes as an **International Verify Order**.

Inputs

- Business Name (Required or Business ID)
- Business ID (Required or Business Name)
- Country ISO (Required)
    - Country / Jurisdiction is required for AsiaVerify, but not required for Kyckr.

Outputs

International Verify **[Canada, Europe, and APAC] - Priority for Q2 Launch**

Attribute	**Description**
Business Name	Legal name as registered with local authority
Business Address	Registered address on file
Registration Status	Current standing (e.g., active, dissolved, suspended)
Registration Date	Date of incorporation or formation
Registration Source	Authoritative registry the data was retrieved from
Shareholders / Officers	People data found in the registry documents

Not in scope for Q2 Launch, to be considered for future

- UBO Graph - Map beneficial ownership chains across entities
- Risk Assessment - Automated risk scoring based on entity attributes and signals
- AML Report - Sanctions, PEP, and watchlist screening for business and individuals
- Monitoring Report - Ongoing alerts for changes to registration status, address, or ownership

Competitive Differentiation

- **Unified platform** - Customers can verify businesses operating internationally (and/or internationally originated businesses with or without US presence) through the U.S.'s leading KYB platform. No more stitching together point solutions per geo.
- **No data trade-off** - International coverage through Middesk maintains best-in-class business data fidelity globally. We've done the sourcing work so customers don't have to compromise.

- **Future moats** - differentiation deepens over time through:
    - **UBO verification (fast-follow)** - competitors like Trulioo already claim UBO in their international KYB offering; prioritizing this quickly closes a potential market gap
    - **Best-in-class global data** - filling gaps in international registry data (e.g., physical addresses) to deliver fresher, more comprehensive business data than vendors or registries provide natively
    - **Entity graph and resolution** across jurisdictions and data sources
    - **Fraud network effects** - aggregate signals across the Middesk customer base to detect risky patterns
    - **Full-stack KYB roadmap** - AML, monitoring layered on the same platform
    - **Workflow innovation** - owning more of the end-to-end experience (e.g., UBO attestation flows) to improve customer workflows beyond just data delivery

Goals

Priority [Q2/Q3 2026]

- **P0:** Launch international coverage (Canada, EU, APAC) by late April / early May to unblock enterprise pipeline and establish Middesk as a global KYB player
    - **Measurable Results:**
        - GA + PR Release of International Product in Q2
        - # of Deals Closed Lost due to International Coverage down to 0 (for covered regions in 2026)
        - Enterprise deal progression — X% more deals advance past early qualification stages where lack of international data previously led to disqualification
- **P1:** Drive adoption among existing customers and new prospects expanding internationally
    - **Measurable Results:**
        - X% of in-scope current customers activate international verifications within 90 days of launch
        - # of new prospects won where international KYB coverage was a contributing factor
- **P1:** Validate data quality and coverage gaps for future phase prioritization
    - **Measurable Results:**
        - Collect feedback on match rates and missing attributes
- **P1:** Gather customer and market intel to inform the international roadmap
    - **Measurable Results:**
        - Capture requirements and feature gaps from MVP usage and early sales conversations to prioritize future phases (e.g., UBO, additional geos, data enrichment)

Non-Goals [Q2 2026]

- **International Sole Prop Verification:** Out of scope for launch. No strong vendor solution exists — most default to KYC on the individual. Lower priority given limited market pressure.
- **UBO Verification / People Match:** Out of scope for Q2 launch, but scoped as a near-term fast-follow. Competitors (e.g., Trulioo) already claim UBO in their international KYB offering, and early sales conversations indicate this is a key requirement. Prioritize for the next phase.
- **Cached Data:** All verifications will be pulls and requests to our data vendors; unlikely for us to host and cache.
- **Input to other product lines:** This launch focuses on Verify report only; no integration with Fraud, Prefil, or Entity.

Requirements

P0: Initial Launch [Q2 2026]

- **Data Pipelines**
    - **Partner Integration**s: Integrate with Kyckr, AsiaVerify, and Reg Hub (Canada-focused) for priority geos: Canada, Europe, APAC. Final vendor mix TBD - may leverage all three.
    - **Vendor Package Evaluation**: Assess each vendor's pricing tiers and package options. Vendors often offer lighter/cheaper searches (e.g., business existence check) before a full report - evaluate whether to mirror this in our product experience.
    - **Per Call**: Return P0 Business Attributes using a per-API call approach as mentioned
- **API and Data Schema**
    - Extend existing Verify API to accept international search requests and entities
        - Need to accept: Business Name, Business ID, ISO Country Code (to check with vendors)
        - Need to output:
            - Business Name
            - Business Address
            - Registration Status
            - Registration Date
            - Registration Source
            - ISO Code
    - Include **International Verify as an Order**
        - New Product / Sub-Product Type
- **Data Modeling & Entity Resolution**
    - We won't be able to support full entity resolution, but we do plan to apply a ranking and scoring model as part of the Q2 launch or
      as a fast-follow. This means that users won't need to select the custom
- **Pricing & Packaging**
    - Define Middesk's pricing model for international verifications, informed by:
    - Vendor pricing structures and per-geo cost variation
    - Government fee differences by jurisdiction
    - Whether to offer tiered search depth (light check vs. full report)
    - Determine bundling strategy — particularly how international KYB packages with global sanctions/PEP screening
    - Evaluate vendor billing models to inform requirements for billing on our side
- **Compliance / Gating**
    - Legal review of API design and outputs to keep compliant with specific regional privacy laws (GDRP, PIPL, etc.)
    - API structured to remove people-related data in cases where we could be liable for privacy violations.
- **Customer Experience**
    - API Documentation for International Verify Fields and schema
    - Dashboard updates to surface international verification results, coverage, and reporting
    - Assess impact on adjacent product areas (e.g., policies) and scope required updates to support international entities (likely to be P1).
    - Examples of international businesses and their results across different regions/countries
    - Coverage benchmarks for specific geos/regions

P1: Forward-Looking Enhancements

- **Data Pipelines**
    - Expand partner integrations to additional geos (LATAM, MEA, etc.) or more robust data attributes
    - Add real-time data refresh via direct pipelines to priority registries

- **API and Data Model**
    - Add enriched attributes (e.g., UBO data, industry codes, financial indicators)
    - Extend International Verify capabilities to other product lines (e.g., Prefill, Fraud, Agentic).
    - Add non-deterministic outputs (risk scores and entity graph).
    - Add non-English language support for product experience
- **Legal Considerations**
    - Extend compliance framework
    - Build audit logging and consent management features for sensitive markets
- **Customer Experience**
    - Add localized documentation and error messaging for non-English markets
    - Enable customers to select preferred data sources or registries per request

Designs [TBD]

Dependencies

- **Engineering**
    - API infrastructure readiness to support international entity model and new input/output fields
    - Integration development with Kyckr, Reg Hub, and AsiaVerify APIs (authentication, rate limits, error handling)
    - Data normalization layer to standardize responses across different registry formats
- **Legal**
    - Sign-off on data handling for GDPR, PIPL, and regional privacy requirements
    - Review of vendor contracts (Kyckr, Reg Hub, AsiaVerify) for data usage rights and liability
    - Guidance on people-data exclusion logic to avoid compliance exposure
- **GTM**
    - Sales enablement materials and pricing model for international tier
    - Customer communication plan for existing accounts with international expansion needs
    - PR/launch coordination for GA announcement in Q2

Risks

- **Data Quality/Coverage Gaps** - Match rates and attribute availability may vary significantly by region; could impact customer trust early on
- **Vendor Reliability** - Dependency on Kyckr, AsiaVerify, and Reg Hub uptime and response latency. If all three vendors are retained, Kyckr could serve as a fallback for Canada and APAC, partially mitigating single-vendor risk in those geos. Europe remains single-vendor dependent.
- **Legal Blockers** - Late-stage compliance concerns (e.g., people-data leakage) could delay launch or limit geo availability
- **Adoption Uncertainty** - Unclear demand signal; customers may wait for UBO/enhanced attributes before activating
- **Scope Creep** - Pressure to add Enhanced Onboarding attributes (Directors, Shareholders) could jeopardize April/May timeline

Order Flows [Draft]

Order Types for International

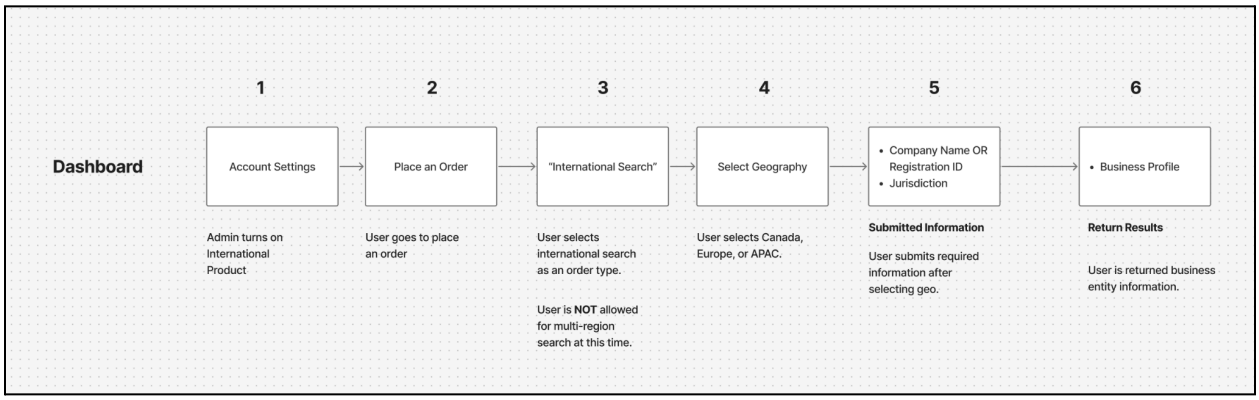
International coverage is sold as regional product SKUs (Canada, Core Europe, Extended Europe, APAC), each with one order type - **International Verify** (Business Registration information + people data - directors, shareholders, UBO where available).

	International Verify
Data	Business name, registration number, status, incorporation date, address Officers/Directors + Shareholders + UBO (where available)
Use case	Full KYB - onboarding, compliance, due diligence

Product SKU	**Markets**	**International Verify**
Canada	Canada	1.5x
Core Europe	UK, France, Germany, Netherlands, Ireland, Italy, Belgium, Austria, Denmark, Finland, Sweden, Spain, Luxembourg, Slovenia, Latvia	2.5-3x
Extended Europe	8 partial-coverage markets (Gibraltar, Guernsey, Jersey, Norway, Greece, Macedonia, Cyprus, Estonia)	n/a
APAC	China, Hong Kong, Singapore, New Zealand, Malaysia, Japan, Taiwan, India, Vietnam, Thailand, Indonesia, Philippines, South Korea	3-4x
Australia	Australia	4x

Multiples are simplified for packaging / customer use and benchmarked against Verify. C*urrently informed by: https://coverage.kyckr.com/ - need to reconcile with commercial agreements (pricing) + margin goals*.

ORDER FLOW - [See here for more detailed flows]



Once the required inputs for each product below is submitted - **one business will be returned**. To fulfill an order for International Verify - a registration number must be submitted to start to resolve one business.

Canada Product

Canada has a lower-price multiple relative to the other geos because of its proximity to the US and similar registry structure. However, this should be one of the international products that should have quicker adoption because of the overlap of presence from businesses that operate in the US and Canada.

Order	Required Inputs	Outputs
International Verify	Submitted information must include: ● Business or Corporate Number AND Jurisdiction (single)	● Business Report will return: ○ General Information ■ Name ■ Standardized Type ■ Number (Registration) ■ Registry Type ■ Standardized Status ■ Registry Status ■ Registered Jurisdiction ■ Registered Date ■ Status Updated Date ○ Addresses ■ Registered Address ■ Parties ■ Standardized Type ■ Registry Type ■ Name ■ Effective Date ■ Home Address ■ Mail Address ○ Events ■ Registry Type ■ Date

A localization consideration for Canada is Bill 96.

- **What it is:** Quebec's 2022 French language law (fully enforced June 2025) requiring French as the primary language of all business - B2B and B2C - including contracts, websites, customer service, and commercial docs
- **Enforcement**: Complaint-driven, not proactive. Fines of $3K-$30K CAD per offense. OQLF takes an "incentive-based" approach with foreign companies that have no Quebec establishment.
- **Middesk risk**: Low unless selling directly to Quebec-HQ'd customers. Bilingual data output via a language parameter is a product feature, not a compliance requirement.

Scenario	Does Bill 96 Apply?	Why

Middesk sells to a Quebec-HQ'd business (e.g., a Montreal fintech)	Yes	Bill 96 applies to B2B relations - organizations providing B2B services are required to inform and serve their clients in French, including software firms selling to other companies
Middesk sells to a US or non-Quebec business that verifies Quebec merchants	No	Bill 96 governs the relationship between Middesk and its customer, not the data subjects. Your customer may have their own Bill 96 obligations, but that's their problem.
Middesk has no Quebec-based customers	No	No nexus, no exposure

Core Europe Product

These are the geographies that have the deepest coverage (i.e. access to UBO registries), but also make up the bulk of expected KYB demand. **Markets**: UK, France, Germany, Netherlands, Ireland, Italy, Belgium, Austria, Denmark, Finland, Sweden, Spain, Luxembourg, Slovenia, Latvia

Order	Required Inputs	Outputs
International Verify	● Company Number OR Company Name ● isoCode	● Company Name ● Company Number ● Registered Address ● Registration or Foundation Date ● Registration Status ● Legal Form ● Company Activity ● Registration Authority ● *expanded details where available* ● Share capital structure ● Company Officials (incl. Directors) - including function, date of birth and address. ● Shareholders (Beneficial owners) - including share count, share percentage and ID information. ● Ultimate Beneficial Owners - where filed in structured form.

Extended Europe Product

<u>The complete version of International Verify is not available for Extended Europe</u>**.** These jurisdictions lack Shareholders and UBO data per Kyckr coverage, so we'd have to call that out and price appropriately. **Markets:** Gibraltar, Guernsey, Jersey, Norway, Greece, Macedonia, Cyprus, Estonia

Order	Required Inputs	Outputs
International Verify	● Company Number OR Company Name ● isoCode	Business Search will return list of matching businesses with: ● Business Name ● Jurisdiction

		● Status ● City ● Type ● Description ● Jurisdiction Status ● Created Date ● Status Date

APAC Product

Key input note: Unlike Canada and Europe, APAC requires a language parameter on every request. This mirrors AsiaVerify's API structure (EN = English, OG = Original Language, ALL = both). This is a product schema decision that should be made at the API level from day one.

Markets: China, Hong Kong, Singapore, Australia, New Zealand, Malaysia, Japan, Taiwan, India, Vietnam, Thailand, Indonesia, Philippines, South Korea

Sync vs Async - Most countries return data in the same API call. HKG and IDN (Basic), and PHL (Lite) are async — you either provide a notifyUrl callback or poll the Order History endpoint.

Order	**Required Inputs**	**Outputs**

International Verify	● Country Code
	● keyword — company name (fuzzy search supported) or registration number
		● Company Name & Number
		● Registration Status & Date of Incorporation
		● Registered Address (Region, City)
		● Coverage: 13 jurisdictions (Sync) + Philippines (Async)
		  ○ Officers & Directors (roles, appointment dates)
		  ○ Shareholders (ownership percentages)
		  ○ Coverage: 14 jurisdictions — HKG & IDN are Async
		  ○ India: no shareholder info available
		  ○ SGP has a Basic Plus variant that adds nationality, ID type/number, and residential address for all individuals

AsiaVerify does allow for an Advanced - Deep Due Diligence Order for China. But it may make sense to include later as an add-on since it’s unclear how much demand it will bring. It includes:

- Everything in Basic, plus:
  - Administrative Penalties
  - Abnormal Operations & Serious Irregularities
  - Equity Pledged
  - Court Records & Law Enforcement
  - Ultimate Beneficial Owner
  - Coverage: China only

Key APAC Considerations

- China PIPL (Personal Information Protection Law)
  - **What it is:** China's equivalent of GDPR, effective November 2021. Governs cross-border transfer of personal data of Chinese nationals, including director/officer names, DOBs, and ID numbers.

    - **Impact on output:** Returning Chinese director/officer PII to a US or European customer is a cross-border data transfer requiring impact assessment, consent chain, and potentially security review.
    - **Product consideration:** Consider whether to persist Chinese officer/director data or return it real-time only (reduces PIPL exposure). This is partly why China Advanced is priced as a standalone SKU - the compliance overhead is real.
    - **Penalties**: Fines up to RMB 50 million or 5% of previous year's global revenue.
- India - Data Gap
    - **What it is:** India's MCA registry does not return shareholder data through standard KYB API responses (confirmed by AsiaVerify's coverage matrix).
    - **Impact on output:** The "International Verify" tier for India will not include shareholders. This must be disclosed clearly in documentation and API response so customers don't assume International Verify = full coverage for all 14 markets.
- Indonesia & Philippines - Async Responses
    - **What it is:** Per AsiaVerify, Hong Kong (International Verify), Indonesia, and Philippines return responses asynchronously — results are not returned in the same API call. Customers must provide a callback URL or poll an order history endpoint.
    - **Impact on output:** API design must support async responses for these jurisdictions. SLA/latency expectations will differ from synchronous markets. Indonesia in particular can take 45+ seconds due to registry slowness.
- South Korea - PIPA
    - **What it is:** Korea's Personal Information Protection Act imposes strict consent and cross-border transfer rules similar to China's PIPL but slightly less restrictive.
    - **Impact on output**: Ensure data vendor handles consent for cross-border transfer of Korean director PII. Medium friction - not a product blocker but requires DPA coverage.

Future Roadmap

International KYB: Potential Roadmap

This roadmap outlines a potential phased approach to expanding Middesk's International Verify product beyond the Q2 2026 GA launch. Each phase builds on validated customer demand and lessons from prior phases.

Roadmap Overview

Phase	Theme	Timeline	Key Deliverables	Gating Criteria
Phase 1 **GA Launch**	Establish global KYB presence	Q2 2026 (Apr/May)	International Verify for Canada, Core/Extended Europe, APAC (14 markets). API + Dashboard.	Current phase - in progress
Phase 2 **UBO & Enhanced**	From verification to compliance-grade KYB	Q4 2026	UBO verification, Directors & Shareholders for all geos, Enhanced Onboarding tier.	Phase 1 GA shipped. Legal sign-off on people-data handling (GDPR, PIPL). Validated customer demand from Phase 1 usage.
Phase 3 **Scale & Moats**	Network effects and full-stack global KYB	2027+	LATAM/MEA expansion, entity graph & resolution, fraud network effects, product line integration (Prefill, Fraud, Agentic).	UBO data pipeline live. Compliance framework extended. Customer demand signal from Phase 2.

Competitive Context by Phase

Each phase is designed to close specific competitive gaps and build toward differentiation that compounds over time.

Phase	Competitive Gap Closed	Moat Deepened
Phase 1	Middesk can now compete for international deals previously lost to regional vendors	Unified US + Global KYB platform - no stitching point solutions
Phase 2	Closes UBO gap vs. Trulioo; matches compliance-grade expectations for enterprise buyers	Entity graph foundations; consent/audit infrastructure for regulated markets
Phase 3	Full-stack KYB+AML+monitoring; geographic parity; product suite integration no competitor can match	Fraud network effects compound with scale - cross-border risk signals and data advantage widen over time

Open Items for Roadmap Refinement

Question	Impacts	Owner / Timeline
Should International Verify merge into domestic Verify or remain standalone?	Phase 2+ UX and packaging strategy. Customer expectations around attribute parity.	Product + CX. Decide post-Phase 1 based on attribute gap.
How important is it to reduce the friction of finding and returning one business?	Phase 3 (potentially earlier) - UX and Entity Resolution	Product + Data Platform. Collect signals through Phases 1-2.
What consent/audit infrastructure is needed for people data (GDPR, PIPL)?	Phase 2 timeline and scope. Whether to build infrastructure now or at Phase 2.	Legal + Engineering. Needed before Phase 2 kickoff.
Which LATAM/MEA geos to prioritize and with which vendors?	Phase 3 scope and vendor selection.	GTM + Product. Collect signals through Phases 1-2.
How much do we want to sell into international customers that are based abroad?	This could impact localization requirements - not only in technical but also operational considerations.	LT

Strategic Trade-off: Coverage Width vs. Depth: A sequencing decision for the international roadmap is whether to prioritize coverage width (adding new geos like LATAM, MEA) or coverage depth (closing gaps in existing regions - e.g., sole props, missing attributes, async reliability). *Guiding principle: Width wins deals, depth keeps them.*

Width vs. Depth Comparison

Dimension	Width (New Geos)	Depth (Existing Regions)
Pipeline	High - unlocks net-new deals	Moderate - unblocks activation, prevents churn
Retention	Low - same gaps follow you	High - better match rates → more volume
Eng Effort	High per geo (vendor + legal + normalization)	Variable - some tractable, some vendor-blocked
Competitive	Visible - wins RFPs and coverage checks	Durable - wins POCs and renewals
Network Effects	Broader but shallow	Deeper, compounds over time
Risk	Spreading thin erodes trust	Slower expansion loses deals to competitors

Investment Prioritization Matrix

Specific initiatives mapped by estimated impact and effort. Use this to sequence width vs. depth investments within each roadmap phase.

Initiative	Type	Impact	Effort	Recommendation
Sole prop verification (existing geos)	Depth	Med-High	High	Investigate vendor options; if no path, consider KYC fallback. Scoping needed before committing.
Add in more data types and sources at the international level to improve data quality and match rates.	Depth	High	Medium	Highest-ROI depth investment. Compounds over time - prioritize in Phase 2.
Fill UBO / shareholder gaps	Depth	High	High	Quick win if alternate vendors or registry sources exist. Document gap clearly in the interim.
LATAM expansion (e.g., Brazil, Mexico)	Width	High	High	Strong pipeline signal needed. Evaluate vendor coverage and legal requirements before committing.
MEA expansion (e.g., UAE, Saudi)	Width	Medium	High	Niche demand. Defer unless specific enterprise deals require it.
Add 2-3 high-demand LATAM geos (targeted)	Width	Med-High	Medium	Hybrid approach - selective width without full regional buildout. Best paired with depth work.

Recommended Sequencing

- **Phase 2 -** Prioritize Depth: Enhance coverage in live regions (UBO, sole prop investigation, match rate improvements, async reliability). Validated customers in existing geos generate the adoption signal and revenue base that funds geographic expansion. Width without depth creates a coverage story that breaks the moment a customer tries to verify a sole prop in Germany.
- **Phase 3 -** Width + Continued Depth: With a proven playbook from Phases 1-2, expand to new geos (LATAM, MEA) while layering risk intelligence and product integration. By this point, depth investments have compounded into a data quality moat that new-geo launches inherit.
- **Key decision inputs:** (1) Pipeline $ blocked by geo gaps vs. $ at risk from depth issues in live regions. (2) Vendor feasibility for sole prop and missing-attribute coverage. (3) Customer activation and match rate data from Phase 1. These signals should be actively collected starting at GA.

Customer Signal Triggers

Each phase transition should be gated by concrete customer and market signals, not just internal timelines. The following signals from each phase should inform when and how to prioritize the next.

From Phase	Signal to Collect	Informs
Phase 1	Adoption rate among in-scope customers within 90 days. Match rate and missing attribute feedback. # of deals citing UBO as a blocker.	Phase 2 scope and geo prioritization for UBO.
Phase 2	UBO usage volume and customer feedback. Compliance team feedback on consent/audit tooling. Sales pipeline for AML/screening asks. Customer requests for LATAM/MEA geos.	Phase 3 geo expansion priority list. Product integration sequencing.

Phase 2: UBO & Enhanced Attributes (Q4 2026)

Theme: From verification to compliance-grade KYB

- This is the highest-priority fast-follow. Competitors like Trulioo already claim UBO in their international KYB offering, and early sales conversations indicate this is a key customer requirement. Shipping this quickly closes a significant competitive gap.

Key Deliverables

- **UBO Verification:** Map beneficial ownership chains across entities in supported jurisdictions (Core Europe first, where registry UBO data is most available)
- **Directors & Shareholders:** Surface named individuals in leadership roles and registered ownership stakes across all covered geos
- **Industry Classification:** Business activity codes (SIC, NACE) from registry data where available
- **Enhanced Onboarding Tier:** Productize as the “Complete” order type, combining off-the-shelf attributes with enriched people data
- **Consent & Audit Infrastructure:** Build consent management and audit logging for people-data handling in GDPR/PIPL-regulated markets

Expected Impact

- Close competitive gap vs. Trulioo on international KYB with UBO
- Increase deal close rates for compliance-heavy verticals (fintechs, neobanks) that require people-level verification
- Lay the entity graph foundation for Phase 3 risk scoring and network effects

Dependencies & Risks

- **Legal:** GDPR and PIPL sign-off on cross-border transfer of people data (directors, UBOs). China PIPL in particular requires an impact assessment and consent chain for returning Chinese officer/director PII.

- **Vendor:** Kyckr already supports UBO for Core Europe. AsiaVerify offers Directors/Shareholders but India has no shareholder data. Need to validate coverage gaps per geo.
- **Adoption risk:** Customers may have been waiting for this before activating international verifications; monitor Phase 1 adoption signals for validation.

Phase 3: Scale & Competitive Moats (2027+)

Theme: Network effects and full-stack global KYB

With entity-level and people-level data established in Phases 1-2, Phase 3 combines geographic expansion, risk intelligence, and product integration to build durable competitive moats.

Key Deliverables

- **Geographic Expansion**
  - Expand to LATAM and MEA regions, prioritized by enterprise pipeline signal. Add real-time data refresh via direct registry pipelines for priority markets. Stack-rank new geos based on demand data collected in Phases 1-2.
- **Product Line Integration**
  - Extend international entity data to Prefill, Fraud, and Agentic product lines. Add non-English language support for the full product experience. Enable customers to select preferred data sources or registries per request.
- **Global Entity Graph & Resolution**
  - Build cross-jurisdiction entity resolution connecting business relationships, ownership chains, and affiliations worldwide. This is the foundation for Middesk's long-term differentiation - richer connections across the global entity landscape that no single-geo vendor can replicate.
- **Workflow Innovation**
  - Own more of the end-to-end compliance experience, including UBO attestation flows, localized documentation and error messaging, and workflow tooling that goes beyond data delivery to improve customer operations.

Gating Criteria

UBO data pipeline live from Phase 2. Compliance framework extended for AML obligations. Established international customer base with validated usage patterns. Entity graph foundations built from Phase 2 data. Clear pipeline signal for new geos from GTM.

Open Questions

- **On CX and UX**
    - Open Question: Product Packaging - Add-on vs. Standalone
        - Should International Verify be an add-on to existing Verify or a standalone order type?
            - **Add-on pros**: Consistent UX, single integration path, positions Verify as a global product
            - **Standalone pros**: Output schema is intentionally limited (no people data, fewer attributes) - bundling may set mismatched expectations vs. domestic Verify
            - **Recommendation to pressure-test:** Launch as standalone to set clear scope expectations; merge into Verify once attribute parity improves
- **On API Design**
    - If vendors return people data (e.g., director names) and we strip it before serving to customers - does that processing alone create liability?
    - Are there any countries in scope (e.g., China/PIPL, Singapore/PDPA) where business registry data could still trigger compliance obligations?
    - What changes if we later add people data (Directors, UBO)? Should we build consent/audit infrastructure now?
    - Any upcoming regulations (e.g., EU AML Package, Corporate Transparency Act equivalents) we should design for?
- **On Vendor & Contractual**
    - Who holds liability if a vendor returns inaccurate or stale data that causes downstream harm?

Resources

- LInear Initiative
- AsiaVerify API - APAC Vendor
- Kyckr API - EU and Canada Vendor
- Trulioo API - Competitor